

vFPC User Guide

Version 4.0.0

VATSIM Flight Plan Checker for EuroScope

Applicable to vFPC 4.0.0

VFPC Guide

vFPC is a EuroScope plugin for UK VATSIM that checks filed IFR departure flight plans against the current VFPC restriction data and shows the result directly in the departure list.

> **Note**
>
> It is recommended that your EuroScope UK Sector Files and VATSIM UK Controller Pack are current before using vFPC.

Guides

This user guide is divided into the following sections:

- Installation and Configuration — installing and configuring vFPC.
- Using vFPC — normal operation and viewing validation results.
- Validation Reference — result codes and how to interpret them.
- Troubleshooting and Limitations — common problems and known limitations.
- Reporting Issues — getting support and reporting issues.

> **Controller Responsibility**
>
> vFPC is a controller aid, not a clearance engine. It is an assistive validation tool and is not a substitute for controller knowledge or judgement. Controllers remain responsible for understanding applicable departure procedures, SID restrictions, flight level capping and the semicircular rule.

Installation and Configuration

This guide explains how to install the vFPC plugin into EuroScope and configure it for use. The process only needs to be completed once.

Download

vFPC is no longer included with the VATSIM UK Controller Pack.

Download the latest version from the GitHub Releases page.

After downloading `VFPC.dll` move it to the folder `%APPDATA%\EuroScope\UK\Data\Plugin\VFPC\`.

The plugin will work from any location, but the above path is the recommended location for consistency with other EuroScope plugins.

> **Note**
>
> vFPC stores its configuration and data files using the standard Windows Application Data folders. These locations are determined automatically by Windows and no configuration is normally required.
>
> For more information about **%APPDATA%** and **%LOCALAPPDATA%** folders see the Microsoft documentation:
>
> • Microsoft Learn - KnownFolder IDs

Plugin Configuration

Before you use the plugin it needs to be configured within EuroScope as follows:

> **Allow Draw on Types**
>
> The plugin does not require **Allowed To Draw On Types** to function. Please **DO NOT** alter these settings.

Load the plugin

1. Start EuroScope and open the required profile (`.prf`).
2. From the menu bar, select **Other Set** → **Plug-ins**.
3. From the Plug-ins Dialog, click the **Load** button and navigate to the folder where you moved `VFPC.dll`.
4. Select `VFPC.dll` and click **Open**.
5. `VFPC.dll` should now appear in the list as shown below.

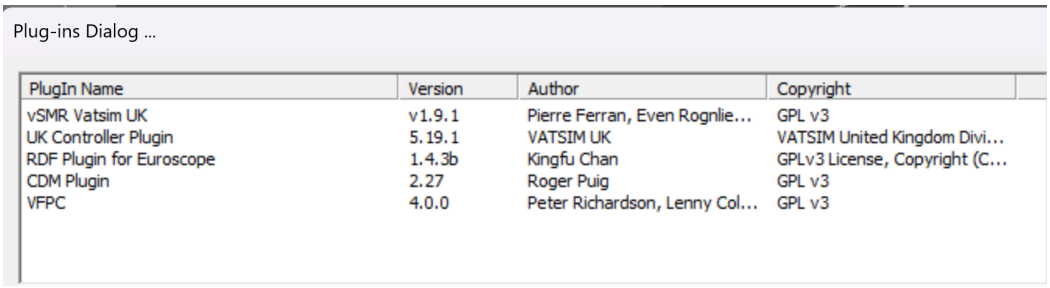


Figure 1: EuroScope Plugin Dialog List.

Departure List Configuration

The final part of configuration is to add a column to the Departure List which is used to display the validation results.

Add the vFPC column

1. Click **S** in the top left of your departure list to open the 'Departure list columns setup dialog'.

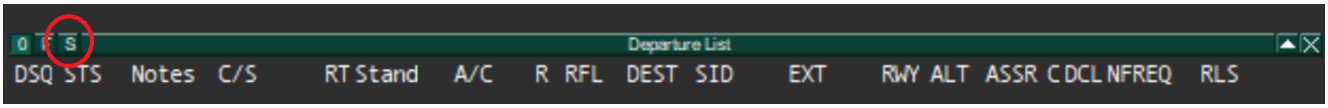


Figure 2: Departure list menu.

2. Click **Add Item**. A new item named **Callsign** is added to the bottom of the list.
3. Select the new item and change **Tag Item Type** to **VFPC/VFPC**.
4. Set **Header name** to **FPL**, **Width** to **4**, and leave **Align to center** unchecked.

Configure mouse actions

1. Set **Left button** to **VFPC / OPTIONS**.
2. Set **Right button** to **UK Controller Plugin / Open SRD Search**.
3. The Departure List columns setup dialog should now look similar to Figure 3.

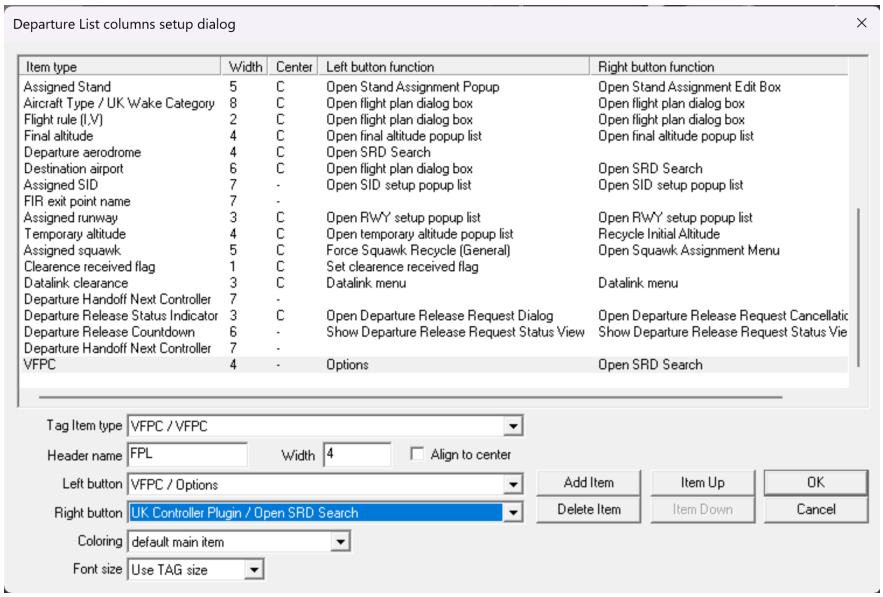


Figure 3: Departure list columns setup

The vFPC plugin is now configured and ready for use.

> **FPL Column Position**
>
> You can move the position that the FPL column appears on the Departure List by using the 'Item Up' and 'Item Down' buttons.

Updating vFPC

New versions of vFPC are published on the GitHub Releases page.

To update vFPC:

1. Close EuroScope.
2. Download the latest version of `VFPC.dll`.
3. Replace the existing `VFPC.dll` in your vFPC plugin folder with the new version.
4. Restart EuroScope.

Your existing Departure List configuration does not normally need to be changed when updating vFPC.

> **Note**
>
> Release notes are provided with each release and should be reviewed for any additional installation or configuration requirements.

Using vFPC

Once installed and configured, vFPC operates automatically while you are controlling. Validation results are displayed in the **FPL** column of the EuroScope Departure List.

Normal Operation

vFPC validates IFR departure flight plans for the active departure airport using the currently loaded validation data.

A flight plan is normally validated when:

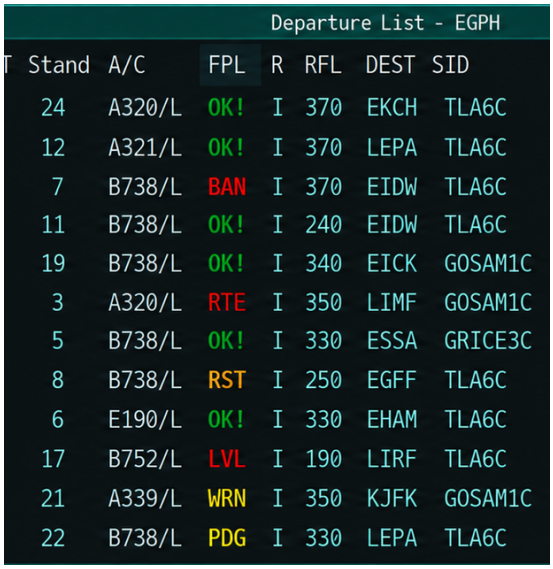
- A new IFR flight plan is detected.
- A relevant part of an existing flight plan is changed.
- Updated validation data is loaded.

VFR flight plans are not validated.

> **Note**
>
> vFPC requires a departure runway to be assigned before flight plan validation can take place.

The FPL Column

The **FPL** column within the Departure List displays a short code indicating the current validation result.



Departure List - EGPH

T	Stand	A/C	FPL	R	RFL	DEST	SID
	24	A320/L	OK!	I	370	EKCH	TLA6C
	12	A321/L	OK!	I	370	LEPA	TLA6C
	7	B738/L	BAN	I	370	EIDW	TLA6C
	11	B738/L	OK!	I	240	EIDW	TLA6C
	19	B738/L	OK!	I	340	EICK	GOSAM1C
	3	A320/L	RTE	I	350	LIMF	GOSAM1C
	5	B738/L	OK!	I	330	ESSA	GRICE3C
	8	B738/L	RST	I	250	EGFF	TLA6C
	6	E190/L	OK!	I	330	EHAM	TLA6C
	17	B752/L	LVL	I	190	LIRF	TLA6C
	21	A339/L	WRN	I	350	KJFK	GOSAM1C
	22	B738/L	PDG	I	330	LEPA	TLA6C

Figure 5: vFPC validation results in the EuroScope Departure List.

For example:

- **OK!** — the flight plan passed validation.
- **WRN** — advisory information is available.
- **RTE** — the route requires attention.
- **PDG** — validation is pending.
- **VFR** — the flight plan is VFR and is not validated.
- **OFF** — validation has been disabled for the flight plan.
- **OVR** — a controller override has been applied.

The code is intended to provide a quick indication only. See the Validation Reference for a full explanation of each result.

Using the FPL Column

The **FPL** column is also used to access vFPC functions.

Left-click — vFPC Options

Left-click the **FPL** result for a flight plan to open the vFPC options menu.

As shown in **Figure 6**, the menu provides four options:

- **Show Checks (SUMMARY)**
- **Show Checks (FULL)**
- **Toggle Override**
- **Toggle Checks**

The purpose and use of each option are described in the following sections.

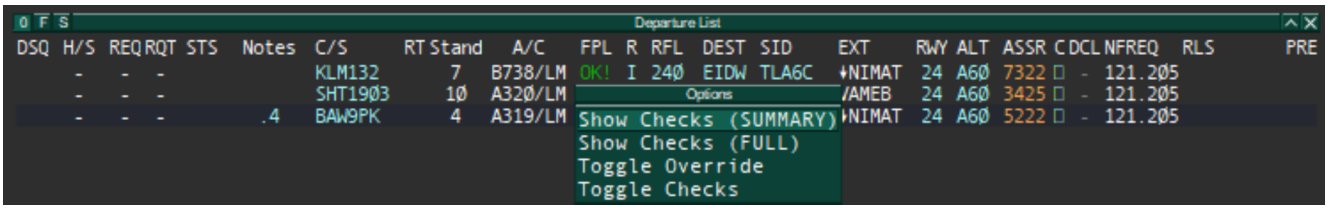


Figure 6: vFPC options available from the Departure List.

Right-click — SRD Search

Right-click the **FPL** result to open **SRD Search** using the UK Controller Plugin.

This provides quick access to the applicable Standard Route Document information when reviewing a flight plan.

Viewing Validation Results

More detailed information about a validation result can be displayed in the EuroScope message window by selecting **Show Checks (SUMMARY)** or **Show Checks (FULL)** from the menu shown in **Figure 6**.

Show Checks (SUMMARY)

SUMMARY displays the principal validation result together with a short explanation. This will normally provide sufficient information to understand why a flight plan has not validated successfully.

Show Checks (FULL)

FULL displays the individual checks performed by vFPC and their results. Use this when more detail is required or when investigating an unexpected validation result.

> **Note**
>
> Validation details are displayed in the EuroScope message window only when **Show Checks (SUMMARY)** or **Show Checks (FULL)** is selected.

Toggle Override

Toggle Override allows the controller to override the validation status displayed in the **FPL** column.

An override does not change the filed flight plan or the underlying validation result. The **FPL** column displays **OVR** to indicate that a controller override has been applied.

Select **Toggle Override** again to remove the override.

Toggle Checks

Toggle Checks disables validation for the selected flight plan. The **FPL** column displays **OFF** while validation is disabled.

Select **Toggle Checks** again to re-enable validation.

This can be useful where vFPC validation is not appropriate for a particular flight plan.

When a Flight Plan Does Not Validate

A result other than **OK!** does not necessarily mean that the flight plan should simply be rejected or changed.

1. Review the code displayed in the **FPL** column.
2. Select **Show Checks (SUMMARY)** to view the reason.
3. If further information is required, select **Show Checks (FULL)**.
4. Compare the result with the applicable procedures and current flight plan.
5. Take the appropriate controller action.

If vFPC does not behave as expected, see Troubleshooting and Limitations.

> **Controller Responsibility**
>
> vFPC is a controller aid. Validation results should be considered alongside current procedures and the controller's own assessment of the flight plan.

Validation Reference

vFPC displays a short validation code in the **FPL** column of the EuroScope Departure List. The code provides a quick indication of the validation status of the flight plan.

This page explains the validation colours and result codes used by vFPC. For information about viewing Summary and Full validation results, see Using vFPC.

How Validation Works

When an IFR flight plan is ready for validation, vFPC checks the filed information against the data available for the departure airport.

The diagram below provides a simplified overview of the validation process. Individual checks may depend on the results of earlier checks.

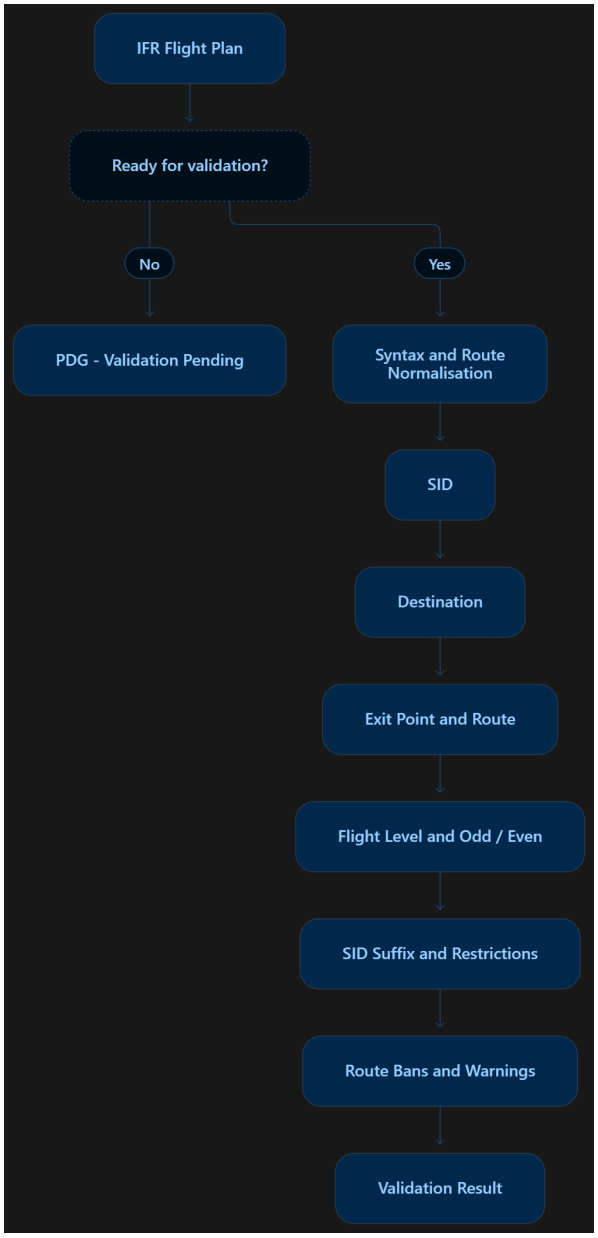


Figure 7: Simplified vFPC validation process.

The validation data is primarily generated from the NATS Standard Route Document (SRD) and may also include airport-specific operational rules and local procedures.

Result Colours

The colour of the FPL column provides the quickest indication of the validation status.

Colour	Meaning
Green	Flight plan validated successfully.
Yellow	Validation is pending or advisory information is available.
Amber	Flight plan contains a level, odd/even or suffix issue that should be reviewed.
Red	Validation failure. Controller action required.
Grey	Flight plan is not currently being validated (for example VFR traffic or validation disabled).
Cyan	Controller override has been applied.

> **Note**
>
> The exact colours used are configurable within the vFPC configuration file. The colours shown above represent the default behaviour.

Result Codes

The following table provides a quick reference to the result codes displayed in the **FPL** column. More detailed information about each result is provided below.

Code	Meaning
OK!	All validation checks passed
WRN	Advisory information is available
PDG	Validation is pending
VFR	VFR flight plan — not validated
OFF	Validation has been disabled for the flight plan
OVR	Controller override applied
SID	SID validation failed
DST	Destination validation failed
XIT	Exit-point validation failed
RTE	Route validation failed
LVL	Flight-level validation failed
OER	Odd/even flight level validation failed
SFX	SID suffix validation failed
RST / **RST**	SID or route restriction requires attention
BAN	Applicable route or SID ban triggered
SYN	Flight plan syntax validation failed
ERR	Error encountered during validation

OK! indicates that all applicable validation checks have passed.

No further vFPC action is required.

WRN indicates that the flight plan has passed validation, but advisory information is available.

Review the Summary result for details of the warning.

PDG indicates that validation is pending.

This is normally a temporary condition while vFPC is waiting for information required to validate the flight plan, for example:

- Airport validation data is still loading.
- A departure runway has not yet been assigned.

Validation will proceed when the required information becomes available.

VFR indicates that the flight plan is VFR.

vFPC validates IFR departure flight plans only. VFR flight plans are therefore not validated.

OFF indicates that validation checks have been disabled for the flight plan using **Toggle Checks**.

Select **Toggle Checks** again to re-enable validation.

OVR indicates that the controller has applied an override to the validation status displayed in the **FPL** column using **Toggle Override**.

The override does not change the filed flight plan or the underlying validation result.

Select **Toggle Override** again to remove the override.

SID indicates that the flight plan has failed SID validation.

Review the Summary result for details of the SID validation failure.

DST indicates that the destination has failed validation against the applicable route requirements.

Review the Summary result for details of the destination validation failure.

XIT indicates that the exit point has failed validation against the applicable route requirements.

Review the Summary result for details of the exit point validation failure.

RTE indicates that the filed route has failed validation against the applicable route requirements.

Review the Summary result for details of the route validation failure.

LVL indicates that the requested flight level has failed validation against the requirements for the applicable route.

Review the Summary result for details of the flight level validation failure.

OER indicates that the requested flight level has failed the odd/even flight level requirements for the applicable route.

Review the Summary result for details of the odd/even validation failure.

SFX indicates that the SID suffix has failed validation against the requirements for the applicable route.

Review the Summary result for details of the SID suffix validation failure.

RST or **RST** indicates that a SID or route restriction applies to the flight plan.

- **Red** indicates that the restriction has caused validation to fail.
- **Amber** indicates that the restriction is advisory.

Review the Summary result for details of the applicable restriction.

BAN indicates that the flight plan has triggered an applicable route or SID ban.

Review the Summary result for details of the applicable ban.

SYN indicates that the flight plan has failed syntax validation.

Review the Summary result for details of the syntax validation failure.

ERR indicates that vFPC encountered an error while attempting to validate the flight plan.

Review the Summary result for further information. If the cause is not clear, refer to Troubleshooting and Limitations.

Controller Responsibility

vFPC is an advisory validation tool designed to assist controllers.

Controllers remain responsible for applying current procedures, local instructions, SRD requirements, SID restrictions, level capping requirements and the semicircular rule.

An **OK!** result should not be used as a substitute for operational knowledge and judgement.

Troubleshooting and Limitations

This page covers common issues that may prevent vFPC from validating a flight plan or displaying the expected result.

For information about individual validation result codes, see the Validation Reference.

vFPC Does Not Appear in the Departure List

Check that:

- `VFPC.dll` has been loaded in EuroScope.
- The **VFPC/VFPC** tag item has been added to the Departure List.
- The **FPL** column is visible.

If necessary, repeat the configuration steps in Installation and Configuration.

A Flight Plan Is Not Being Validated

vFPC validates IFR departure flight plans for the active departure airport.

A flight plan may not be validated if:

- The flight plan is VFR.
- A departure runway has not yet been assigned.
- Validation checks have been disabled using **Toggle Checks**.
- The flight plan does not belong to the airport currently being handled by vFPC.
- The required airport validation data is not available.

The code displayed in the **FPL** column may provide more information. See the Validation Reference.

Validation Remains Pending

A **PDG** result indicates that vFPC is waiting for information required to perform validation.

This may occur while airport validation data is loading or when a departure runway has not yet been assigned.

If **PDG** remains displayed after the required information is available, select **Show Checks (SUMMARY)** or **Show Checks (FULL)** and review the information displayed in the EuroScope message area.

An Unexpected Validation Result Is Displayed

If a result does not appear to agree with the filed flight plan:

1. Select **Show Checks (SUMMARY)**.
2. If necessary, select **Show Checks (FULL)** for the individual validation checks.
3. Compare the result with the applicable UK procedures and the filed flight plan.

If the result still appears incorrect, see Reporting an Issue.

Known Issues

There are currently no known issues.

Issues that have been resolved are documented in the release notes.

Known Limitations

vFPC is designed to validate IFR departure flight plans against the available vFPC validation data. It does not validate VFR flight plans.

Validation is dependent on the coverage and accuracy of the available validation data. A successful validation does not remove the controller's responsibility to ensure that a flight plan and clearance are appropriate.

Reporting an Issue

If you are unable to resolve a problem using the Troubleshooting and Limitations page, support is available through the vFPC Discord server.

Getting Support

Joining the vFPC Discord Server

Use the link below to join the vFPC Discord server:

Join the vFPC Discord server

If you do not already have a Discord account, you will be prompted to create one or sign in before joining the server.

Raising a Support Ticket

Once you have joined the server, open a support ticket in the appropriate support channel.

Information to Provide

When reporting a problem, provide as much of the following information as applicable:

- vFPC version.
- EuroScope version.
- Callsign.
- Departure and destination aerodromes.
- Assigned departure runway.
- SID.
- EOBT.
- Aircraft type.
- Requested flight level.
- Filed route.
- The result displayed in the **FPL** column.
- The **SUMMARY** result.
- The **FULL** result, where relevant.
- What result you expected.
- The relevant vFPC log file.

Using the vFPC Log File

vFPC creates a new log file each time the plugin is started. The log contains diagnostic information about the operation of vFPC and flight plan validation.

The log files are normally located in:

`%APPDATA%\EuroScope\UK\Data\Plugin\VFPC\log`

Log files use the following naming format:

`vfpc-YYYYMMDDHHMMSS.log`

The log file can be useful when investigating an unexpected validation result or other problem with vFPC.

When reporting a problem, you may be asked to attach the log file covering the period when the problem occurred.

Detailed Logging

vFPC supports additional diagnostic logging for investigating problems.

Detailed logging should normally only be enabled when requested by vFPC support. Instructions for enabling it will be provided if required.